2. It recommends, in cases of disasters of severe magnitude, relief in repayment of loans or grant of fresh loans on concessional terms to the persons affected by such disasters.

3. It exercises the general superintendence, direction and control of the National Disaster Response Force (NDRF). This force has been constituted for the purpose of specialist response to a threatening disaster situation or disaster.

4. It authorises the concerned department or authority to make the emergency procurement of provisions or materials for rescue or relief in any threatening disaster situation or disaster. In such cases, the standard procedure requiring inviting of tenders is deemed to be waived.

5. It prepares an annual report on its activities and submits it to the central government. The central government causes it to be laid before both Houses of Parliament.

State Disaster Management Authority

Under the Disaster Management Act, 2005, every state government should establish a State Disaster Management Authority (SDMA) for the state.

 **Composition**

An SDMA consists of a chairperson and other members, not exceeding nine. The Chief Minister of the state is the ex-officio chairperson of the SDMA. The chairperson of the State Executive Committee is the ex-officio member of the SDMA. The other members, not exceeding eight, are nominated by the chairperson of the SDMA. The chairperson of the SDMA designates one of the members as the vice-chairperson of the SDMA. The chairperson of the State Executive Committee acts as the ex-officio chief executive officer of the SDMA.

 **Functions**

An SDMA has the responsibility for laying down policies and plans for disaster management in the state. Its functions include the following:

1. To lay down the state disaster management policy.

2. To approve the State Plan in accordance with the guidelines laid down by the NDMA.

3. To approve the disaster management plans prepared by the departments of the government of the state.

4. To lay down guidelines to be followed by the departments of the government of the state for the purposes of integration of measures for the prevention of disasters and mitigation in their development plans and projects and provide necessary technical assistance thereof.

5. To coordinate the implementation of the State Plan.

6. To recommend the provision of funds for mitigation and preparedness measures.